

1. SOP-114: How to Submit a Coffee Reimbursement

This Standard Operating Procedure governs the submission of beverage-related expense claims. It supersedes SOP-113, which was retracted following the events of last March. Read it all. We will know.

1.1. Eligibility

- The beverage must be coffee. Tea is governed by SOP-117.
- The beverage must have been consumed *during* working hours. Coffee consumed *because of* working hours is out of scope and should be raised with HR.
- The beverage must not exceed **€4.50**. Beverages exceeding this cap may still be submitted, with the understanding that the amount over €4.50 will be deducted from your dignity.
- Decaf is not coffee. We made this clear in the all-hands.

1.2. Procedure

To file a claim, complete the following steps **in order** :

1. Locate the receipt. We acknowledge that this is the hardest step. If you cannot locate the receipt, proceed anyway; we will pretend together.
2. Photograph the receipt under "even lighting." Even lighting is defined in Annex C of SOP-002 and involves a lightbox we no longer own.
3. Submit the photograph to the expense portal, along with a one-sentence justification that does not use the words "obviously," "literally," or "as discussed." The portal does not accept these words and will silently refuse your claim if it sees them. We will not tell you which one you used.

The numbers above are the steps in our internal tracker. The layout engine, possessed of more taste than we are, rennumbers them as 1, 2, 3 in the rendered output. We have stopped fighting it.

1.3. Nesting, and when to abuse it

Some claims involve more than one beverage. In that case the ordered list above becomes the *outer* list and each beverage gets its own *inner* list of substeps:

- First beverage of the morning:
 - Receipt photo,
 - Statement of *intent* (mandatory since Q2),
 - Approval from your direct supervisor's direct supervisor.
- Second beverage of the morning:
 1. Receipt photo,
 2. Written justification of why a second beverage was necessary,
 3. Approval from a tribunal of three peers, convened ad-hoc.

- Third beverage of the morning:
 - We are not authorising this.

The marker kinds change between the outer level (-) and the nested level under "Second beverage" (1 .). This is, against our better judgement, supported. Switching marker kinds at the *same* level, however, is treated as two adjacent lists rather than one:

- a bullet item, which ends this list,
1. and an ordered item, which starts a fresh one.

1.4. Right-aligned markers

Long claims involve many items. The numbered-list marker right- aligns against the inside edge of the gutter, so that 9 . and 10 . line up at the period and the indented text column stays flush regardless of how many digits each marker takes:

1. one,
2. two,
3. three,
4. four,
5. five,
6. six,
7. seven,
8. eight,
9. nine,
10. ten,
11. eleven,
12. twelve.

If you have submitted twelve coffee receipts in a single quarter, please contact your supervisor before submitting any more. We are concerned for you.

1.5. Audit log

Every claim is logged. The log is retained for **seven years** . The log is not, in any meaningful sense, ever *read* . Filing a claim is therefore mostly a private spiritual exercise — which is why we ask you to keep the tone respectful, and to refrain from including, in your one-sentence justification, references to whichever member of senior leadership most recently appeared on the standup whiteboard with a frowny face next to their name.